

To address developing markets, we must look at technologies that are clearly innovative, easy to use, require minimal investment in IT infrastructure and technical manpower, are priced cost-effectively and come packaged with extensive knowledge-based support. Businesses are looking to save costs in a competitive environment, which is the reason why we think the InstaSafe model of delivering trust and security on a subscription plan will be attractive to users.

### **Q** How does cloud adoption help InstaSafe to resolve those challenges?

Cloud adoption is increasing but there are a lot of security concerns. Typically, consultants and solutions service providers assemble a patchy set of security point products to address those concerns, which is not necessarily the best way to go on a long-term basis. At InstaSafe, we have made our solution attractive to businesses as it gives organisations the agility to quickly deploy and scale their application infrastructure while closely integrating the security. Further, we have ensured that our solution is easy to deploy, manage and monitor by the IT staff, and that the end users too, find it easy to use.

Unlike a hardware-based product that takes weeks to have the box delivered and then integrated with the existing infrastructure, our Security-as-a-Service offering can be quickly deployed on any existing hardware. Organisations can also right-size their services and scale as they grow, rather than invest in infrastructure that they may never fully use and, therefore, realise faster ROI.

### **Q** Why would an enterprise need to start relying on a Security-as-a-Service (SaaS) model instead of deploying its own team of IT security experts?

The SaaS model clearly stands out because of the agility it offers. It promises quick deployments, and a

pricing that is subscription based, and hence does not require upfront capital investments in servers and other infrastructure that quickly depreciate in value. Hiring a large number of security experts and developing, running and debugging IT security software in-house is not feasible any more, because of the acute shortage of top quality security professionals. Legacy methods also have the management overhead of regularly rolling out patches, in order to make sure that all systems have been correctly configured and upgraded to the new software. Therefore, it makes far more technical and business sense to instead partner with a provider who monitors the threat landscape for you, provides patches quickly and is able to roll them out automatically over the cloud.

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*A national cyber security policy is certainly vital for the country.*  
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### **Q** How does InstaSafe Secure Access enable an advanced security layer on top of a hybrid cloud infrastructure?

The solution offered by InstaSafe provides on-demand, scalable, secure access for all users connecting with their corporate issued device or a BYOD, to access applications, located anywhere – the public cloud, the private cloud or on-premise. This is based on the ‘need-to-know’ access model used in military networks. Our solution creates an ‘Enterprise Black Cloud’, which is essentially a completely invisible network, and is accessible only after the user and the device that is being used to connect is first verified, and then a level of trust is established. As part of the seven layers of security, InstaSafe Secure Access binds the users to the device(s), ensuring their credentials don’t work on any other device,

and it only allows access to specific applications based on the ‘need-to-know’ access model.

### **Q** Is it difficult for hackers to gain backdoor access to a hybrid environment?

All environments, whether hybrid or not, are vulnerable to backdoor attacks, and this is due to the fact that the users and the devices used by them are the weakest links in the enterprise security landscape. Despite the best defences in place, user endpoints can be easily compromised and so the hacker can gain backdoor entry to the enterprise network, including a hybrid one. Once inside, the hacker is able to move laterally with minimum effort. This kind of backdoor entry is feasible due to the trust placed on endpoints once they are inside the network. Google and some other large corporations have started to tackle such attacks. Google's BeyondCorp project provides a very good case study about the benefits of not trusting user endpoints, and provides context sensitive access.

InstaSafe Secure Access is based on the very same principles defined in SDP (software defined perimeter), which ensure that the enterprise network is a ‘Black Cloud’ and access is granted to the user and device only after a certain trust level is established.

### **Q** What are the big obstacles faced when securing hybrid data centres, and how does your solution save costs for enterprises?

Hybrid data centres require solutions that are flexible, and even better, programmable. Maintaining security across these set-ups (whether a public or private cloud) is different due to the network visibility, access and scalability. Hence, the ideal security solutions to protect hybrid data centres are programmable and scalable, yet easy to deploy, maintain and monitor. InstaSafe Secure Access is a ‘software only’ solution delivered as a service.